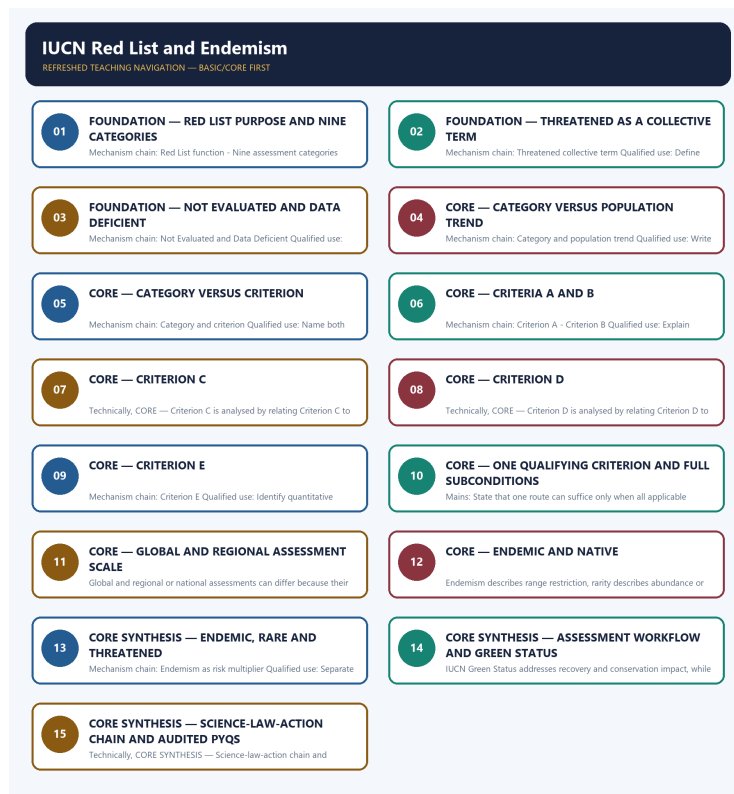


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

IUCN Red List and Endemism - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

IUCN Red List and Endemism - Solved Practice Workbook 5

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 5

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Red List function?	5
Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Red List function?	5
Q3. Which statement uses Red List function without changing its scale, parameter or status?	5
Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Red List function?	5
Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Nine assessment categories?	6
Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Nine assessment categories?	6
Q7. Which statement uses Nine assessment categories without changing its scale, parameter or status?	6
Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Nine assessment categories?	6
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Threatened collective term?	7
Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Threatened collective term?	7
Q11. Which statement uses Threatened collective term without changing its scale, parameter or status?	7
Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Threatened collective term?	7
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Not Evaluated and Data Deficient?	8
Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Not Evaluated and Data Deficient?	8
Q15. Which statement uses Not Evaluated and Data Deficient without changing its scale, parameter or status?	8
Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Not Evaluated and Data Deficient?	8
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Category and population trend?	9
Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Category and population trend?	9
Q19. Which statement uses Category and population trend without changing its scale, parameter or status?	9
Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Category and population trend?	9
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Category and criterion?	10
Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Category and criterion?	10
Q23. Which statement uses Category and criterion without changing its scale, parameter or status?	10
Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Category and criterion?	10
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion A?	11
Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion A?	11
Q27. Which statement uses Criterion A without changing its scale, parameter or status?	11

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion A?	11
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion B?	12
Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion B?	12
Q31. Which statement uses Criterion B without changing its scale, parameter or status?	12
Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion B?	12
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion C?	13
Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion C?	13
Q35. Which statement uses Criterion C without changing its scale, parameter or status?	13
Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion C?	13
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion D?	14
Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion D?	14
Q39. Which statement uses Criterion D without changing its scale, parameter or status?	14
Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion D?	14
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion E?	15
Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion E?	15
Q43. Which statement uses Criterion E without changing its scale, parameter or status?	15
Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion E?	15
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies One qualifying route?	16
Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of One qualifying route?	16
Q47. Which statement uses One qualifying route without changing its scale, parameter or status?	16
Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about One qualifying route?	16
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Assessment scale?	17
Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Assessment scale?	17
Q51. Which statement uses Assessment scale without changing its scale, parameter or status?	17
Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Assessment scale?	17
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Endemic and native?	18
Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Endemic and native?	18
Q55. Which statement uses Endemic and native without changing its scale, parameter or status?	18
Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Endemic and native?	18
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Endemic, rare and threatened?	19
Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Endemic, rare and threatened?	19
Q59. Which statement uses Endemic, rare and threatened without changing its scale, parameter or status?	19

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Endemic, rare and threatened?	19
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Endemism as risk multiplier?	20
Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Endemism as risk multiplier?	20
Q63. Which statement uses Endemism as risk multiplier without changing its scale, parameter or status?	20
Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Endemism as risk multiplier?	20
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Assessment workflow?	21
Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Assessment workflow?	21
Q67. Which statement uses Assessment workflow without changing its scale, parameter or status?	21
Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Assessment workflow?	21
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Green Status distinction?	22
Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Green Status distinction?	22
Q71. Which statement uses Green Status distinction without changing its scale, parameter or status?	22
Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Green Status distinction?	22
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Science-law-action chain?	23
Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Science-law-action chain?	23
Q75. Which statement uses Science-law-action chain without changing its scale, parameter or status?	23
Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Science-law-action chain?	23
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary?	24
Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?	24
Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?	24
Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary?	24

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE 25

VERIFIED OBJECTIVE-ONLY PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT	25
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	25
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	27
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	27
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	28
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	30
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	30
ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS	32

IUCN Red List and Endemism - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Red List function?

A. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. B. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. C. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. D. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe.

Answer: A. Explanation: The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Red List function?

A. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. B. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. C. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. D. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category.

Answer: B. Explanation: The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q3. Which statement uses Red List function without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. B. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. C. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. D. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions.

Answer: C. Explanation: The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Red List function?

A. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. B. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. C. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. D. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit.

Answer: D. Explanation: The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Nine assessment categories?

A. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. B. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. C. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. D. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Nine assessment categories?

A. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. B. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. C. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. D. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q7. Which statement uses Nine assessment categories without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. B. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. C. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. D. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Nine assessment categories?

A. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. B. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. C. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. D. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Threatened collective term?

A. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. B. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. C. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. D. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Threatened collective term?

A. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. B. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. C. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. D. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E.

Answer: B. Explanation: Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q11. Which statement uses Threatened collective term without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. B. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. C. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. D. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.

Answer: C. Explanation: Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Threatened collective term?

A. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. B. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. C. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. D. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category.

Answer: D. Explanation: Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Not Evaluated and Data Deficient?

A. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. B. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. C. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. D. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Not Evaluated and Data Deficient?

A. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. B. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. C. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. D. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E.

Answer: B. Explanation: Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q15. Which statement uses Not Evaluated and Data Deficient without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. B. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. C. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. D. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.

Answer: C. Explanation: Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Not Evaluated and Data Deficient?

A. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. B. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. C. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. D. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe.

Answer: D. Explanation: Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Category and population trend?

A. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. B. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. C. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. D. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.

Answer: A. Explanation: A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Category and population trend?

A. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. B. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. C. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. D. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.

Answer: B. Explanation: A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q19. Which statement uses Category and population trend without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. B. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. C. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. D. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions.

Answer: C. Explanation: A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Category and population trend?

A. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. B. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. C. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. D. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions.

Answer: D. Explanation: A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Category and criterion?

A. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. B. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. C. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. D. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text.

Answer: A. Explanation: Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Category and criterion?

A. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. B. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. C. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. D. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold.

Answer: B. Explanation: Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q23. Which statement uses Category and criterion without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. B. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. C. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. D. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount.

Answer: C. Explanation: Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Category and criterion?

A. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. B. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. C. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. D. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E.

Answer: D. Explanation: Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion A?

A. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. B. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. C. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. D. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion A?

A. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. B. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. C. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. D. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q27. Which statement uses Criterion A without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. B. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. C. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. D. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount.

Answer: C. Explanation: Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion A?

A. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. B. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. C. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. D. Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.

Answer: D. Explanation: Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion B?

A. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. B. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. C. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. D. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount.

Answer: A. Explanation: Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion B?

A. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. B. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. C. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. D. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold.

Answer: B. Explanation: Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q31. Which statement uses Criterion B without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. B. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. C. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. D. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion B?

A. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. B. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. C. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. D. Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text.

Answer: D. Explanation: Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion C?

A. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. B. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. C. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. D. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion C?

A. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. B. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. C. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. D. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year.

Answer: B. Explanation: Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q35. Which statement uses Criterion C without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. B. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. C. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. D. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion C?

A. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. B. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. C. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. D. Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions.

Answer: D. Explanation: Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion D?

A. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. B. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. C. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. D. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount.

Answer: A. Explanation: Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion D?

A. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. B. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. C. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. D. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year.

Answer: B. Explanation: Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q39. Which statement uses Criterion D without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. B. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. C. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. D. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms.

Answer: C. Explanation: Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion D?

A. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. B. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. C. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. D. Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold.

Answer: D. Explanation: Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Criterion E?

A. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. B. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. C. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. D. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year.

Answer: A. Explanation: Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Criterion E?

A. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. B. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. C. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. D. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic.

Answer: B. Explanation: Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q43. Which statement uses Criterion E without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. B. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. C. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. D. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic.

Answer: C. Explanation: Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Criterion E?

A. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. B. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. C. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. D. Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount.

Answer: D. Explanation: Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies One qualifying route?

A. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. B. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. C. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. D. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of One qualifying route?

A. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. B. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. C. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. D. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q47. Which statement uses One qualifying route without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. B. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. C. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. D. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about One qualifying route?

A. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. B. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. C. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. D. The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Assessment scale?

A. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. B. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. C. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. D. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms.

Answer: A. Explanation: Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Assessment scale?

A. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. B. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. C. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. D. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened.

Answer: B. Explanation: Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q51. Which statement uses Assessment scale without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. B. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. C. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. D. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment.

Answer: C. Explanation: Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Assessment scale?

A. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. B. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. C. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. D. Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year.

Answer: D. Explanation: Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Endemic and native?

A. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. B. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. C. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. D. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Endemic and native?

A. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. B. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. C. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. D. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other.

Answer: B. Explanation: Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q55. Which statement uses Endemic and native without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. B. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. C. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. D. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment.

Answer: C. Explanation: Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Endemic and native?

A. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. B. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. D. Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic.

Answer: D. Explanation: Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Endemic, rare and threatened?

A. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. B. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. C. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. D. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened.

Answer: A. Explanation: Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Endemic, rare and threatened?

A. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. B. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. C. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. D. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other.

Answer: B. Explanation: Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q59. Which statement uses Endemic, rare and threatened without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. B. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. C. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. D. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other.

Answer: C. Explanation: Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Endemic, rare and threatened?

A. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. B. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. D. Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms.

Answer: D. Explanation: Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Endemism as risk multiplier?

A. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. B. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. C. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. D. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.

Answer: A. Explanation: Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Endemism as risk multiplier?

A. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. B. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. D. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.

Answer: B. Explanation: Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q63. Which statement uses Endemism as risk multiplier without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. B. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. C. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. D. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred.

Answer: C. Explanation: Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Endemism as risk multiplier?

A. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. B. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. C. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. D. Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened.

Answer: D. Explanation: Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Assessment workflow?

A. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. B. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. C. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. D. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Assessment workflow?

A. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. B. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. D. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q67. Which statement uses Assessment workflow without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. B. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. C. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. D. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Assessment workflow?

A. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. B. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. C. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. D. The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Green Status distinction?

A. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. B. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. D. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit.

Answer: A. Explanation: IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Green Status distinction?

A. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. B. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. D. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct.

Answer: B. Explanation: IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q71. Which statement uses Green Status distinction without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. B. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. C. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. D. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category.

Answer: C. Explanation: IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Green Status distinction?

A. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. B. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. C. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. D. IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other.

Answer: D. Explanation: IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Science-law-action chain?

A. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. B. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. D. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Science-law-action chain?

A. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. B. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. C. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. D. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q75. Which statement uses Science-law-action chain without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. B. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. C. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. D. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Science-law-action chain?

A. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. B. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. C. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. D. The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ boundary?

A. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. B. The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. C. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. D. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category.

Answer: A. Explanation: Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ boundary?

A. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. B. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. C. The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. D. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category.

Answer: B. Explanation: Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. B. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. C. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. D. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe.

Answer: C. Explanation: Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ boundary?

A. Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. B. Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. C. A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. D. Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred.

Answer: D. Explanation: Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED OBJECTIVE-ONLY PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Audited ledgers route 2019 Indian endemism and habitat matching, 2022 species identification, 2023 marsupial distribution, 2024 natural-habitat pairs and 2026 Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation. They are carried as answer-free demands; no objective key or unstated current range, trend or assessment year is inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: order the Red List categories correctly and identify the correct definition of "threatened" versus "Data Deficient."
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: species-specific case studies (Great Indian Bustard, Gharial, various Western Ghats amphibians) are used to illustrate the endemism-extinction risk link.

2026 PYQ Integration

Status: 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	22	Western hoolock gibbon conservation status, habitat, and arboreal adaptation	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (Ans-2026-GS1-Provisional); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Western hoolock gibbon conservation status, habitat, and arboreal adaptation

This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	23	Country-animal natural habitat pairs (Brazil-Indri, Indonesia-Elk, Madagascar-Bonobo)	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Country-animal natural habitat pairs (Brazil-Indri, Indonesia-Elk, Madagascar-Bonobo)

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	Prelims GS-I	22	Wildlife species naturally found only in India	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	29	Wildlife species and natural Indian habitats matching	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	Prelims GS-I	47	Species identification Golden Mahseer Nightjar Spoonbill Ibis	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	12	Marsupials natural habitat and distribution in India	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Wildlife species naturally found only in India
- Wildlife species and natural Indian habitats matching
- Species identification Golden Mahseer Nightjar Spoonbill Ibis
- Marsupials natural habitat and distribution in India

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **ANALYSIS:** Criterion-based Prelims questions (e.g., "a species with very small population size even without decline can be classified as...") are best solved by recalling that any one of Criteria A-E suffices for threatened-category qualification.
- **ANALYSIS:** Mains answers on "species conservation strategy" should explicitly separate the scientific-assessment layer (IUCN), the domestic legal layer (Wildlife Protection Act) and the judicial-enforcement layer (courts), showing how they interact in a live case like the bustard.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish Red List category, criterion and population trend. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Red List function. **Named evidence/example:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category and population trend. **Named evidence/example:** A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category and criterion. **Named evidence/example:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit.
- A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions.
- Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Red List function. **Named evidence/example:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category and population trend. **Named evidence/example:** A Red List category states assessed extinction risk, whereas increasing, stable, decreasing or unknown describes population trend; the two fields answer different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Category and criterion. **Named evidence/example:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why Data Deficient is not evidence of low extinction risk. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Nine assessment categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Threatened collective term. **Named evidence/example:** Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage,

taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Not Evaluated and Data Deficient. **Named evidence/example:** Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct.
- Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category.
- Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Nine assessment categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes Not Evaluated, Data Deficient, Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild and Extinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Threatened collective term. **Named evidence/example:** Threatened collectively covers Vulnerable, Endangered and Critically Endangered; it is not a separate tenth category. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Not Evaluated and Data Deficient. **Named evidence/example:** Not Evaluated means the criteria have not been applied, while Data Deficient means evidence is inadequate for a risk assessment; neither means safe. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain Criteria A-E without inventing taxon-specific thresholds. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Criterion A. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion B. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion C. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion D. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion E. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state

variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** One qualifying route. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it.
- Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text.
- Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions.
- Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold.
- Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount.
- The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Criterion A. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion A concerns population-size reduction over the applicable assessment window; no percentage or assessment year is supplied unless the cited assessment provides it. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion B. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion B concerns restricted geographic range together with the applicable fragmentation, decline or fluctuation conditions; range restriction alone must be read with the criterion text. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion C. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion C combines small population size with continuing decline and its applicable population structure conditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion D.

Named evidence/example: Criterion D addresses a very small or very restricted population under the applicable category threshold. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Criterion E. **Named evidence/example:** Criterion E uses quantitative analysis of extinction probability; it is not a synonym for expert opinion or a simple headcount. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** One qualifying route. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records that meeting one applicable criterion can support a threatened category, but the taxon must meet that category's full threshold and subconditions. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Distinguish endemic, native, rare and threatened species. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Endemic and native. **Named evidence/example:** Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemic, rare and threatened. **Named evidence/example:** Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemism as risk multiplier. **Named evidence/example:** Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic.
- Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms.
- Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Endemic and native. **Named evidence/example:** Native means naturally occurring in the stated region; endemic means naturally restricted to the stated region, so every endemic is native there but not every native is endemic. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemic, rare and threatened. **Named evidence/example:** Endemism describes range restriction, rarity describes abundance or occurrence, and threatened status is an assessed extinction-risk class; they can overlap without being synonyms. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemism as risk multiplier. **Named evidence/example:** Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the value and limits of the IUCN Red List for Indian conservation. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Red List function. **Named evidence/example:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment scale. **Named evidence/example:** Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism,

system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment workflow. **Named evidence/example:** The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Green Status distinction. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-law-action chain. **Named evidence/example:** The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit.
- Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year.
- The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment.
- IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other.
- The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Red List function. **Named evidence/example:** The IUCN Red List is a criteria-based scientific assessment of extinction risk; it is not itself an Indian statute or permit. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment scale. **Named evidence/example:** Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment workflow. **Named evidence/example:** The owner links specialist expertise, Species Survival Commission groups, assessment documentation and review; a published category must remain tied to its supporting assessment. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Green Status distinction. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN Green Status addresses recovery and conservation impact, while the Red List addresses extinction risk; one does not replace the other. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-law-action chain. **Named evidence/example:** The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The

conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Show how scientific assessment should translate into law and habitat action. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Category and criterion. **Named evidence/example:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment scale. **Named evidence/example:** Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemism as risk multiplier. **Named evidence/example:** Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-law-action chain. **Named evidence/example:** The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E.
- Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year.
- Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened.
- The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred.
- Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Category and criterion. **Named evidence/example:** Category is the resulting risk class; criterion is the quantitative route used to justify it, so a category name must not be substituted for criterion A, B, C, D or E. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Assessment scale. **Named evidence/example:** Global and regional or national assessments can differ because their geographic scope differs; every status claim must name the assessment scale and year. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Endemism as

risk multiplier. **Named evidence/example:** Restricted range can remove spatial refuge and recolonisation options, but endemism does not automatically make a taxon threatened. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science-law-action chain. **Named evidence/example:** The Great Indian Bustard route separates IUCN risk assessment, Indian legal protection and judicial or infrastructure mitigation; no current population count is inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Routed demands cover Indian endemism, habitat matching and Western hoolock gibbon status, habitat and adaptation; objective keys and unstated current ranges are not inferred. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.